

Cover story

Changing Face of **RURAL INDIA**

Most of rural India is unrecognisable from what it was a decade ago. A confluence of factors has brought a new affluence and urban trappings, from cars to computers.



**MRITYUNJAY
SHARMA**
FARMER,
UTTAR PRADESH

Sharma of Chandauli village in Barabanki is considering replacing his one-year-old Maruti Swift with a Honda City after he started making rich profits from his menthe (mint) oil cultivation. One litre of the oil, which is exported, fetches a farmer around Rs 500 to Rs 575 which has changed the grassroots economy of the district.

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